

Skills Pathfinder (Connecting Talent to Opportunity)

Category	Live or evergreen option
Sponsor / Organization	U.S. Department of Education
Contact	Via Hootcamp Coordinator.
Project type	Software / web app (AI-powered) - match and recommend
Best fit for	Intermediate
Status	Active (challenge ends April 1, 2028). Verify at the source.

Problem Description

The full challenge builds statewide talent marketplaces; the Hootcamp scope is the learner-facing layer, a "skills pathfinder" that turns a resume, transcript, or certificate into clearer next-step options.

Goals and Objectives

Ship an app that parses resumes and transcripts, infers skills, normalizes credential language, and explains matches with editable suggestions.

What You Will Learn

Structured-data modeling, search, explainable recommendations, and civic-service UX.

Resources and Links

- Competition page: [Connecting Talent to Opportunity](#)

Mentorship and Support

Hootcamp weekly sessions (Dr. David Jaramillo, LexisNexis Risk Solutions) and peer-cohort support throughout the build.

Instructors will identify an industry or faculty mentor for the project.

Notes

Long active window; scope to the learner-facing layer for a summer build.